Cthulhu Eternal: An Any-Time Lovecraftian Roleplaying Game

Cheat Sheet Summary of Changes

Localization for Modern Age Settings

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WHAT THIS FILE IS – AND WHAT IT IS *NOT*

The ***Cthulhu Eternal*** System is a multi-era, multi-setting ruleset for tabletop roleplaying. At its core it has a streamlined set of universal d100-based rules which govern most elements of the game. While these universal rules define the core of the game, each era-specific version of the rules (which we call "localizations" of the game) have certain era-specific rules and modifications.

For each such localization, a complete ruleset (or "System Reference Document" on OGL-speak) has been compiled. Such localized SRDs reproduce all the universal material that is the core part of *Cthulhu Eternal's* game "DNA" inserting specific sections into the rules text to deal with the technology, social conventions, or other special things that make the era/setting different from others. These extra rules often describe:

- New skills lists, and sets of protagonist archetypes,
- Special options for running combat in the setting,
- Portrayals of mental illness that capture the beliefs and understanding common to the setting,
- Details of vehicles, poisons, and common diseases of the era, and
- Any other specific modifications the game designers thought would better capture the setting's flavor.

Because an SRD has both the universal rules AND local modifications, each is quite a substantial document (~ 100 pages). They are effectively self-contained rulebooks in their own right: someone could run a game using the SRD alone.

If you are new to the *Cthulhu Eternal* system, the best place to learn the rules (localized to a specific era/setting) is with one of the SRDs. However, once you've learned one localization the system and have a need to familiarize yourself with another, reading through the entire SRD for the new setting is overkill. Most of the rules are similar – what you really want to know is "what's different about this new localization?"

That's exactly what this "Cheat Sheet" is designed to provide you – just the new stuff for a localization. Coupled with your general understanding of the game, this information will get you going quickly. This document definitely is NOT a full rulebook. Also, some minor era-specific details might not get noted here: for those you should refer back to the full details in the SRD (which this document also points to in some places).

Protagonists

The table below shows the set of skills available to Protagonists in Modern Age games. The table also shows the base ratings for each skill, and which can be specialized. The descriptions of each skill may be found on page 9.

Adversity Skills: if your Protagonist gets additional skill picks for enduring an especially harsh upbringing, they can only spend those picks on First Aid, Military Training (type), Regional Lore (type), or Survival (type).

>> Skills and Base Ratings	
Administration (10)	Melee Weapons (30)
Alertness (20)	Military Training (Type) (0)
Anthropology (0)	Natural World (10)
Appraise (10)	Navigate (10)
Archeology (0)	Occult (10)
Art (Type) (0)	Persuade (20)
Athletics (30)	Pharmacy (0)
Charm (20)	Pilot (Type) (0)
Craft (Type) (0)	Psychoanalyze (10)
Disguise (10)	Regional Lore (Type) (0)
Dodge (30)	Research (10)
Drive (20)	Ride (10)
Firearms (20)	Science (Type) (0)
First Aid (10)	Search (20)
Foreign Language (Type) (0)	Stealth (10)
Forensics (0)	Surgery (0)
Harangue (10)	Survival (Type) (10)
Heavy Machinery (10)	Swim (20)
History (10)	Technology Use (0)
Insight (10)	Track (10)
Law (Type) (0)	Unarmed Combat (20)
Medicine (0)	Unnatural (0)

Archetypes

The following archetypes are available for Protagonists in Modern Age games.

List of Archetypes

The following Archetypes are appropriate for Modern era games of Lovecraftian investigation. They don't cover every possible character type but focus on likely protagonists in mystery and investigation tales. The GM is encouraged to develop other archetypes to cover other character types suggested by players. Guidelines for developing new Archetypes may be found in the SRD.

Artist / Craftsperson

RECOMMENDED STATS: DEX

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Appraise 40%
- Art (choose one) 60%
- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Charm 60%
- Insight 60%
- Persuade 60%
- Search 60%

Choose any 5 of these that you don't already have:

- Administration 50%
- Alertness 60%
- Anthropology 40%
- Athletics 70%
- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Harangue 50%
- Heavy Machinery 50%
- Regional Lore (choose one) 40%
- Technology Use 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 3

BONDS: 3

Author / Blogger

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Alertness 50%
- Art (choose one) 50%
- Insight 60%
- Research 60%
- Search 60%
- Technology Use 20%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Anthropology 40%
- Archeology 40%
- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- Harangue 50%
- History 50%
- Law (choose one) 40%
- Occult 50%
- Regional Lore (choose one) 40%
- Science (choose one) 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4

BONDS: 4

Conspiracy Theorist / Expert

RECOMMENDED STATS: CHA, POW

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Firearms 50%

- First Aid 40%
- Natural World 50%
- Navigate 50%
- Search 50%
- Survival (choose one) 50%
- Track 50%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Firearms 60%
- Heavy Machinery 50%
- History 50%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Occult 50%
- Pilot (choose one) 40%
- Ride 50%
- Survival (choose one) 50%
- Unarmed Combat 60%

STARTING RESOURCES: 3

BONDS: 4

Criminal

RECOMMENDED STATS: DEX

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Alertness 40%
- Appraise 40%
- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Harangue 40%
- Law (choose one) 30%
- Stealth 60%
- Search 50%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Administration 50%
- Art (choose one) 40%
- Athletics 70%
- Charm 60%
- Dodge 70%
- Firearms 60%
- Insight 50%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Technology Use 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5

BONDS: 4

Doctor / Nurse

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 30%
- Charm 40%
- First Aid 50%
- Insight 50%
- Medicine 50%
- Science (choose one) 40%
- Search 60%
- Surgery 40%
- Technology Use 30%

Choose any 2 of these that you don't already have:

- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- Military Training (choose one) 40%
- Forensics 40%
- Pharmacy 40%
- Psychoanalyze 50%
- Research 50%
- Science (Type) 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5

BONDS: 3

Historian / Genealogist

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 50%
- Anthropology 50%
- Archeology 50%
- History 70%
- Research 60%
- Technology Use 30%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Art (choose one) 40%
- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- Law (choose one) 40%

- Military Training (Type) 40%
- Persuade 60%
- Regional Lore (choose one) 40%
- Search 60%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4

BONDS: 4

Law Enforcer / Agent

RECOMMENDED STATS: CON, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Alertness 50%
- Athletics 60%
- Drive 50%
- Firearms 60%
- Harangue 60%
- Insight 50%
- Law (choose one) 40%
- Search 50%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Disguise 50%
- Dodge 70%
- First Aid 50%
- Forensics 40%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Persuade 60%
- Regional Lore (choose one) 40%
- Stealth 50%
- Technology Use 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4

BONDS: 3

Librarian / Archivist

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 60%
- Alertness 50%
- Appraise 50%
- Research 60%
- Search 50%
- Technology Use 50%

Choose any 5 of these that you don't already have:

- Anthropology 40%
- Archeology 40%
- Art (choose one) 40%
- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- History 50%
- Law (choose one) 40%
- Occult 50%
- Regional Lore (choose one) 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4

BONDS: 3

Researcher / Scientist

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 50%
- Persuade 60%
- Research 70%
- Science (choose one) 70%
- Search 60%
- Technology Use 40%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Anthropology 40%
- Archeology 40%
- Art (choose one) 40%
- Firearms 60%
- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- Heavy Machinery 50%
- Military Training (choose one) 40%
- Natural World 50%
- Psychoanalyze 50%
- Science (choose another) 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5

BONDS: 2

Technologist

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT, POW

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 50%
- Alertness 50%

- Art (choose one) 40%
- Insight 50%
- Persuade 50%
- Search 50%
- Technology Use 80%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Appraise 50%
- Craft (choose one) 40%
- Firearms 60%
- Heavy Machinery 50%
- Military Training (choose one) 40%
- Navigate 50%
- Pilot (choose one) 40%
- Research 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4

BONDS: 3

White-Collar Worker

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Administration 60%
- Charm 50%
- Insight 50%
- Persuade 50%
- Research 40%
- Technology Use 60%

Choose any 4 of these that you don't already have:

- Appraise 50%
- Art (choose one) 40%
- First Aid 50%
- Foreign Language (choose one) 40%
- Harangue 50%
- History 50%
- Military Training (choose one) 40%
- Occult 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5

BONDS: 3

Income and Costs

A protagonist's "wealth" is represented in an abstract fashion by their Permanent Resources rating (0–20). For games in Modern Age settings, the following approximations can help frame that wealth in terms of the prevalent currency of the day, or by comparison with the costs of common items or expenses.

What does the Resources Rating Mean?

Resources Rating	**Financial Assets, Income and Cash-at-Hand**		
0	Penury	$0	no assets
1-4	Poor	$20k/annum	cheap car, rented apartment
5-8	Average	$50k/annum	ok car, mortgaged home
9-12	Above Average	$100k/annum	good car, part-mortgaged home
13-16	Well Off	$150k/annum	multiple cars, paid-off home
17-18	Rich	$200k/annum	multiple luxury cars, several homes
19	Very Rich	$500k/annum	several prestige cars, mansions
20+	Super Rich	$1m/annum+	sky is the limit

Some representative costs:

- Average living expenses for a single person (excluding rent): $1100/month
- Renting a 1-bedroom apartment in a large city: $3000/month
- Renting a 1-bedroom apartment in a small city or town: $1000/month
- Buying a 3-bedroom house in a large city: $500k-$1m
- Buying a 3-bedroom house in a small city or town: $100k-$400k
- Meal at a quality restaurant: $75
- Takeout meal: $13
- Public transport pass: $100/month
- New (non-prestige-brand) car: $20k
- Prestige-brand car: $55k
- Single-engine plane: $50k-$100k
- Private jet: $1m-$90m

Skills

Skill Descriptions

Administration

Base Rating: 10%

A knowledge of how bureaucracies work and what kinds of forms, paperwork, journals, etc. it invariably generates. Use it to sift through detailed financial records or proceedings of club meetings to find that one quirky point that just doesn't seem to fit the usual pattern.

Use this skill to rapidly navigate your way adeptly through administrative records to find what's important. Note that this skill is primarily about interpreting information you have; if you need to actively go out and track down books, records, etc. that would be covered by the **Research** skill.

Alertness

Base Rating: 20%

Alertness detects danger. Use it to hear a weapon being readied, to understand the mumbling on the other side of a wall, to spot a concealed item hidden under a jacket, or to catch someone who is trying to escape notice using Stealth.

Anthropology

Base Rating: 0%

The study of living human cultures. Use it to understand morals, religious beliefs, customs, and mores, and to identify (but not translate) obscure languages. Where History is about the distant past and Archeology studies physical artifacts, Anthropology is about the behaviors of living cultures and how they relate to each other and the past.

Appraise

Base Rating: 10%

The ability to quickly determine the true (intrinsic) value of an item. This is an important skill in ensuring that bartering exchange deals are favorable to you. It is also helpful in knowing what items or resources others might be willing to trade to obtain.

Archeology

Base Rating: 0%

The study of physical remains of human cultures. Use it to analyze a ruined structure to determine useful information about its purpose long ago or the circumstances of its destruction. Where Anthropology is about living cultures and History is a broad study of the past, Archeology discerns meaning from the artifacts left behind.

Art (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Expertise at creating or performing a work that sways emotions and opinions. It also encompasses knowledge of techniques and trends in your field, and the ability tell a particular creator's real work from a fake. Anyone can draw a rough sketch; the Art skill reflects knowledge, practice, and talent. Each type of Art is a separate skill: Acting, Dance, Forgery, Music, Poetry, Sculpture, Singing, Storytelling, etc.

Athletics

Base Rating: 30%

Your Protagonist trains to get the most out of his or her strength and agility. Strength and Dexterity cover raw physical power and manual dexterity; the Athletics skill represents long practice doing things like running, jumping, climbing, and throwing.

Use Athletics to:

- Outrun someone (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).
- Jump an intimidating gap.
- Climb in a crisis.
- Land safely in a fall of up to three yards.
- Hit a target with a thrown knife or put a grenade exactly on target.
- Catch something without warning, such as intercepting a thrown grenade.

Charm

Base Rating: 20%

Changing someone else's viewpoint or convincing them to do something for you through guile, cunning, "buttering-up", or other such subtle techniques. It's not about threatening them (that's covered by the **Harangue** skill) or using cold logic to convince them (that's **Persuade**) but covers all those other soft-touch methods. With Charm you might be able to connect with an individual on a more personal level – maybe even seduce them – and such changes can become long-

held attitudes or beliefs. If the target of the skill starts from an antagonistic viewpoint, some form of OPPOSED TEST will probably be needed to overcome their negative impression.

Craft (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Making and repairing sophisticated tools and structures. A job that most people could figure out does not require the Craft skill, only an INT or DEX test. Use Craft for specialized work that needs training: Craft (Mechanic) to get a broken apparatus working — or to sabotage one beyond repair; Craft (Locksmith) to open a lock without a key, and so on.

A common specialization is **Craft (Jury-Rigging)** which represents an ability to create lash-ups of equipment to perform a function when the proper tool for the job is unavailable.

The Game Moderator decides whether a task requires Craft. Each Craft type is a separate skill: Blacksmith, Carpenter, Farmer, Jury-Rigging, Locksmith, Mechanic, etc.

Disguise

Base Rating: 10%

Alter your Protagonist's appearance, voice, posture, body language, and mannerisms to avoid recognition without drawing attention.

Dodge

Base Rating: 30%

Evading danger through instinct and reflexes. Use Dodge to avoid an attack. Against firearms and explosives, Dodge is only useful to get to cover (see **DODGING RANGED ATTACKS** in the SRD).

Drive

Base Rating: 20%

Handling any ground-based vehicle or conveyance safely in a crisis. Unless the Game Moderator says otherwise, every Protagonist can drive safely in normal conditions. Use this skill to keep a vehicle safe in a tense pursuit or on dangerous terrain.

Firearms

Base Rating: 20%

Safe and accurate shooting with common firearms in combat. Use it to hit a target despite the adrenaline, panic, and shock of violence interfering with hand-eye coordination.

First Aid

Base Rating: 10%

The initial treatment and stabilization of injuries. Use it to help a character recover lost Hit Points. By comparison, Surgery corrects a severe wound and Medicine ensures long-term recovery. (See **HEALING** in the SRD.)

Foreign Language (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Fluency in another language. Each foreign language is a distinct skill. Having 20% allows halting conversations; at 50% your Protagonist speaks and reads like a native. The greater the skill, the greater the complexity of the information your Protagonist comprehends and the less time it takes. You don't need to roll a Foreign Language skill unless the Game Moderator says the situation is exceptionally difficult.

Forensics

Base Rating: 0%

Gathering detailed information and evidence based on an assessment of human remains. Use it to hypothesize about the cause of a fire, trace the trajectory that a bullet followed, or determine whether a pool of blood is consistent with a major or minor injury.

Harangue

Base Rating: 10%

The art of browbeating someone into agreeing with your point of view or agreeing to do something you want them to do. This technique is not a subtle attempt to engage with their good nature (that's covered by the Charm skill) or their logical reason (that's Persuade) – instead it's all about bluster, shouting, and threats. But sometimes these can be more successful than other techniques, although the individuals on the receiving end are unlikely to enjoy the interaction quite so much.

Heavy Machinery

Base Rating: 10%

Safe operation of a tractor, crane, thresher, steam train, or other big machine in a crisis.

History

Base Rating: 10%

Uncovering facts and theories about human antiquity. Use it to remember or find a key fact about the distant past, recognize an obscure reference, or comb through records that nobody without your deep education could find. While Anthropology is about living cultures and Archaeology studies the meaning of ancient relics, History is a broad study of humanity.

Insight

Base Rating: 10%

Insight obtains information about a person — especially information the subject would rather conceal — through observation, conversation, or examining patterns of behavior and relationships. Use Insight to recognize signs of dishonesty from verbal cues and body language, gauge attitude and intentions, cultivate sources of information about a subject, determine what it would take to get a subject to cooperate, or recognize clues of what a subject wants to conceal.

Insight can notice signs of mental illness but Psychoanalyze would be needed to assist with a specific malady. A subject who deliberately tries to deceive your Protagonist can attempt an opposed test comparing their Persuade against your Protagonist's Insight (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Law (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Use this skill to understand and manipulate the power structures that exist within society, to either influence outcomes or bullshit your Protagonist's way out of trouble.

Different societies have their own systems of law – the understanding of each is a separate skill. Because all societies are based on common human behavior, you can attempt to use your Law skill at *half* chance to navigate the vagaries of an entirely new and unfamiliar social order.

Medicine

Base Rating: 0%

The study and treatment of injury and illness. Use it to diagnose the cause of an injury, disease, or poisoning, identify abnormalities such as toxins or diseases, identify the cause and approximate time of death, identify a dead person's last meal, or prescribe proper long-term care. By comparison, First Aid keeps a patient alive until surgery is possible, and Surgery corrects a severe wound. (See **HEALING** in the SRD).

Melee Weapons

Base Rating: 30%

Lethal use of melee weapons in combat. Use it to hurt or kill an opponent with a knife, axe, club, or other hand-held weapon.

Military Training (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Many people spend a part of their careers in some form of military service to a crown or other empire – whether as part of an army or navy, or even on boats in coastal waters. A great many people are also employed in the giant bureaucracy that keeps the military supplied and functioning. This skill represents first-hand training and experience obtained through time spent in one such military service. Use it to apply military tactics or strategies to a situation, to recall specific details about a particular military unit or corps, or to know your way around common military-issue equipment.

Natural World

Base Rating: 10%

The common understanding of the natural world as practiced by farmers, fishermen, and others who make a living based upon the changing patterns of the weather, tides, etc. It also covers the broad understanding of the natural habits of animals, as well as the different uses of specific plant species. Use this skill to determine whether observed behavior of natural forces or creatures is consistent with "normal" or common patterns, or not.

Navigate

Base Rating: 10%

Finding your way quickly with maps, charts and tables, orienteering, compass, or dead reckoning.

Occult

Base Rating: 10%

The study of the supernatural as understood by human traditions, including things like magick, folklore, and secret societies. Use Occult to examine and deduce the intent of a ritual, or to identify occult traditions, groups, grimoires, tools, symbols, or legends. Occult can never tell a Protagonist what's genuinely unnatural and what's just superstition or mythology. That's the province of the Unnatural skill.

Persuade

Base Rating: 20%

Changing another's deeply held decision or desire. Use Persuade to get your Protagonist's way when the subject is so stubborn, what your Protagonist wants is so valuable, or the deception is so flagrant that Charisma isn't enough.

With Persuade, your Protagonist might convince a witness that what they saw was innocuous and not unnatural, talk a compound leader into helping you cover up an outbreak to avoid a mass panic, or draw useful information out of an unwilling subject. This skill also allows your Protagonist to resist persuasion and interrogation in opposed Persuade rolls (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Pharmacy

Base Rating: 0%

Knowledge of drugs and herbal remedies, from their ingredients and creation, to their effects, uses, and misuses. Use it to identify and produce medicines and antidotes — as well as poisons.

Identifying a drug or medicinal herb requires at least 20% skill. Preparing a particularly powerful treatment safely, such as one with psychoactive effects, requires at least 40% skill or a successful roll. Misusing Pharmacy is a quick way to kill a patient (see **POISON AND DISEASE** in the SRD).

Pilot (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Piloting, navigating, and captaining waterborne, or airborne vehicles. Use it to keep a vessel safe in a crisis, such as through a storm or in a dangerous pursuit. Each vessel type is a separate skill: Airplane, Drone, Helicopter, Airship, Small Boat, Ship, etc.

Psychoanalyze

Base Rating: 10%

The diagnosis and treatment of mental illness. Use it to identify a mental disorder, help a patient recover, talk someone down when a disorder begins to take over, and treat mental illness in the long term. You cannot use Psychoanalysis on yourself. Using Psychoanalysis to aid someone who suffered exposure to Cthulhu Mythos forces might cost the therapist SAN; see **THREATS TO SAN** in the SRD.

Regional Lore (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Most educated people know a little bit about every place, but if you've spent a long time living in (or studying) a specific region you learn so much more. This skill represents a deep understanding of the people, places, and common practices that are unique to one particular region. Use it to recall folktales that villagers tell, unique local words, or unusual ruins and earthworks found in the region. It can also cover quirky superstitions and rites that are particular to the region.

Research

Base Rating: 10%

The ability to find specific information in a large repository or buried in files, records, or ledger books. Use this skill to navigate a library catalogue system, pull out buried details in account records, or otherwise locate whatever relevant information lies buried.

Ride

Base Rating: 10%

Handling, training, and riding an animal—horses, donkeys, camels, whatever. Use it to keep safe on an animal in a crisis and to keep riding animals safe, calm, and healthy.

Science (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

The deep study of the processes of the world. This is more than common schooling; anyone can attempt an INT test to remember facts from whatever (rudimentary) schooling they received. Science is used to find a key insight about the way the universe works — or at least, the way it's supposed to work. Each Science is a separate skill: Astronomy, Biology, Botany, Chemistry, Engineering, Genetics, Geology, Mathematics, Meteorology, Physics, Planetology, Zoology, etc.

Search

Base Rating: 20%

Finding things that are concealed or obscured from plain sight. Searching an abandoned dwelling may not require the Search skill, only time and effort, or a sufficiently high INT. Use Search to find an object that was hidden with the Stealth skill or is otherwise so well hidden or disguised that it needs an expert. The Game Moderator may roll the Search attempt, so you don't know whether your Protagonist succeeded or failed.

Stealth

Base Rating: 10%

Concealing your presence or activities. Use it to hide a weapon, camouflage a position, conceal an occult amulet, pick a pocket, move silently, follow without being seen, or blend into a crowd. A Protagonist attempting Stealth can be detected only by an opposing Alertness or Search skill (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Surgery

Base Rating: 0%

The treatment of an injury or abnormality, by invasive means. By comparison, First Aid keeps a patient alive until surgery is possible, and Medicine ensures long term recovery. (See **HEALING** in the SRD)

Survival (Type)

Base Rating: 10%

Knowledge of the natural world. Use it to plan an expedition, predict weather, recognize when fauna or flora are unusual, use the environment to gather other information, or find food, water, and shelter. Each type of Survival is its own skill. Common types are Desert, Jungle, Tundra, Urban.

Swim

Base Rating: 20%

Most Protagonists can swim for leisure. Use the Swim skill in a dangerous crisis: going a long distance in choppy water, keeping a friend from drowning, or getting to a boat before the tentacled thing below grabs you.

Technology Use

Base Rating: 0%

Nobody needs to make a skill roll to use devices and technologies that are in common use in the era and setting of the game. However, making effective use of highly-specialized or technical apparatus is a different question. In the hands on the untrained, such devices are at best useless, and at worst dangerous. Technology Use is an umbrella skill allowing your Protagonist to successfully use all manner of common technical devices.

For specific applications of Technology Use to bypassing electronic or cyber security, see the box nearby.

Hacking and Cyber Warfare

Many modern settings feature information systems (like the Internet, or forms of Social Media) and real-world items whose operation is controlled by some form of computer or similar device (or A.I.). All such virtual environments and "smart" devices share one important feature – they can be maliciously misused if someone breaks whatever security features exist to authorize legitimate users, control access to confidential information and maintain its integrity, and keep systems available. Efforts to break such controls is normally called "Hacking", although if it is done on a large-enough scale (or by a military force) it might be considered "cyber warfare".

There is no special skill in this version of *Cthulhu Eternal* to cover hacking and cyber warfare – instead they are all considered applications of the **Technology Use** skill. So, whenever Protagonists are trying to guess the password on a laptop or hack into a mainframe to obtain a cult's deepest, darkest secrets they are leveraging their Technology Use skill.

For simple hacking, such as guessing a password, a single **Technology Use** test can get the job done. However, hacking can get much more complex.

A more difficult hacking attempt might use something similar to the Pursuit rules (a series of opposed tests, see page 1). In this, the Protagonist (attacker) is the quarry and the defenders – whether they be an autonomous A.I. Eldritch horror or a corporate security operations center – is the "pursuer". The GM should set the number of wins each side needs (default of 2-3); i.e., how many successes are needed for the PC to break into the system and/or how many the defenders need to achieve to fully boot the PC out of the system (and potentially learn their location, either in the real world or on the network).

Each side rolls tests against their **Technology Use** skill. A success counts as a win; wins on both sides cancel each other out. If both fail their rolls, the higher dice roll wins. A critical success counts as two wins.

Bonuses and penalties can also be applied to **Technology Use** tests, increasing or decreasing the chance of a success. Some examples are:

- Password under the keyboard, or on a Post-It Note: Automatic success
- Easy password: +20%
- Hard, complex password: -20%
- Anti-virus Software in place: +10%
- Corporate level monitoring software: -10%
- Security software powered by Alien technology (e.g., a Mi-Go A.I.): -30%
- Good Firewall in place: -15%

If the Protagonists are trying to gain access to an especially large and sprawling system or network, the GM may decide that it has several "layers". Breaking the first might get the hackers some basic access, but to get to the "crown jewels" they will need to get through further security perimeters. If the entities running the target system are sloppy, there may well be data files in the lower-security "layers" which help someone in escalating their privilege through other layers (at the GM's discretion such lapses might give someone a +20% or +40% bonus to the subsequent attempts).

Track

Base Rating: 10%

Use this to locate the tracks of a specific creature or person and follow them. A test must be made to locate the trail and then again once every ten minutes they are being followed. Penalties or bonuses may apply depending on how long it was since the tracks were made, what the ground is like, what the weather conditions have been since the tracks were made, etc.

Unarmed Combat

Base Rating: 20%

Self-defense. A fight between untrained combatants often involves more shoving and shouting than real violence. Use Unarmed Combat to hurt or kill an opponent with your Protagonist's bare hands (or feet, elbows, teeth, or head).

Unnatural

Base Rating: 0%

Knowledge of the fundamental, mind-shattering secrets of the universe. The things that slithered in the dark corners of the world and the cosmos beyond. Use it to remember, recognize, or research facts about the things humans consider unnatural. This goes far beyond the occult, because the Unnatural skill represents things that are real. Use it to sift through the darkest parts of myth and folklore and recognize which of it is true.

Combat

The basic mechanics of combat do not vary much between different localizations of Cthulhu Eternal, but each has its own tables of weapons and armor as well as elaborations which cover unique forms of conflict or weapons technology.

Attack Skills

For games in Modern Age settings, the following skills are used for combat attacks:

- Use **Firearms** for a gun;
- Use **Firearms** for other aimed weapons (e.g., bow or crossbow);
- Use **Athletics** for a thrown weapon;
- Use **Melee Weapons** for a hand-to-hand weapon;
- Use **Unarmed Combat** for a punch or kick.

Weapons for Modern Age settings

The tables below summarize some representative weapons and vehicles that characters might have access to.

The *Cthulhu Eternal* Modern Era SRD does not include a specific skill for Ranged Weapons, as they are relatively rare — characters who are firing crossbows etc should use the Firearms skill to aim such weapons, while thrown weapons use Athletics as a combat skill.

>> Melee Weapons	
Sample Weapons	Damage
Bare hands and feet	1D4–1*
Brass knuckles or steel-toe boot	1D4*
Taser	STUN
Ordinary knife or hatchet	1D4*
Combat knife, garotte or nightstick	1D6*
Tomahawk, machete, or baseball bat	1D8*
Large sword, chainsaw	2D6*

>> Ranged Weapons		
Sample Weapons	Damage	Base Range
Bow and arrow	1D8	150 yards
Crossbow	1D10	200 yards
Thrown Rock	1D4*	20 yards
Thrown Knife	1D4*	STR×5 feet
Thrown Spear	1D8*	STR×5 yards

*Damage bonus is added for this weapon

>> Small Arms		
Sample Weapons	Damage	Base Range
Small-caliber pistol	1D8	10 yards
Medium Pistol	1D10	15 yards
Carbine or very large pistol	1D12	100 yards for carbine; 20 yards for heavy pistol
Rifle	1D12+2 [Armor Piercing 3]	150 yards
Shotgun blast, close range	2D10	50 yards (full damage up to 10yds; reduced to 1D10 for 10—20yds; reduced to 1D6 for 20+ yards)

>> Automatic and Heavy Weapons				
Sample Weapons	Skill	Base Range	Lethality	Kill Radius
Submachine gun, fully automatic	Firearms	50 yards	10%	1–3 yds
Assault rifle or carbine, fully automatic	Firearms	100 yards	10% [Armor Piercing 3]	1–3 yds
Very heavy sniper rifle	Firearms	250 yards	20% [Armor Piercing 5]	None
Light machine gun	Military Training (Heavy Weapons)	200 yards	10% [Armor Piercing 3]	3 yds
Heavy machine gun	Military Training (Heavy Weapons)	400 yards	20% [Armor Piercing 5]	3 yds
Hand grenade	Athletics	20 yards	15%	10 yds
Improvised explosive device	Military Training (Demolitions)	N/A	15%	10 yds
Grenade launcher	Military Training (Heavy Weapons)	150 yards	15%	10 yds
Rocket-propelled grenade	Military Training (Heavy Weapons)	200 yards	30%	10 yds

>> Selective Fire			
Type of Fire	Ammo Used	Lethality	Kill Radius
Short Burst	3	10%	None
Long Burst	5	10%	1 yd
Short Spray	10	10%	2 yds
Long Spray	20	10%	3 yds

Armor for Modern Age settings

Armor	Armor Rating
Kevlar helmet (adds damage reduction to other armor)	+1
Kevlar vest (concealable)	3
Reinforced Kevlar vest (typical for uniformed police)	4
Tactical body armor (typical for soldiers and SWAT teams), wall or thick door, makeshift vehicle cover	5
Bomb suit; thick wall, concrete, or moderate rock; light vehicle armor	10
Reinforced wall, big rock, or sandbag; medium vehicle armor	15
Heavy vehicle armor or light tank armor	20
Heavy tank armor	25

Healing in Modern Age settings

A doctor can attempt a Surgery or Medicine test once per week: Surgery for critical care of severe wounds; Medicine for poison, disease, and ongoing healing. If treatment succeeds, the patient recovers 1D4 HP. This is doubled with a critical, while a fumble inflicts 1D4 HP damage. At the Game Moderator's discretion, having worn-out tools or poor quality medicines may incur a penalty.

Poisons and Diseases

The rules governing the damage inflicted by poisons and diseases don't vary between localizations, but the specific list of available toxins and infections is guided by the technology and scientific knowledge prevalent in the setting. The table below gives some examples to augment the basic list of common, naturally-occurring poisons.

>> Manufactured Poisons					
Poison	Entry Route	Speed	Lethality	Symptoms	Antidote?
Phosgene gas	Inhalation	2D6 hours	15%	Blistering, coughing blood, asphyxiation	No
Hydrogen cyanide gas	Inhalation	1D6 turns	20%	Asphyxiation	Yes
Sarin gas	Inhalation or absorption through skin	2D6 turns	20%	Muscle contractions, spasms, asphyxiation	Yes
Ricin	Injection or powder inhalation	2D6 hours	20%	Diarrhea, shock, seizures, circulatory failure	No

>> Sample Diseases						
Disease	Route	Speed	CON Test Penalty	Damage	Symptoms	Cure
Bacterial meningitis	Airborne	1D6 days	–40	1D4	Stiff neck, nausea, confusion	Antibiotics
Bacterial pneumonia	Inhalation	1D6 days	None	1D6	Cough, fever, chills	Antibiotics
COVID-19	Inhalation	1D6 days	–20	1D6	Cough, fever, loss of smell; long term immune dysregulation	Some antivirals to treat short-term effects
Gangrene	Dirty wounds	1D6 days	–20	1D4	Discoloration, oozing, numbness	Antibiotics, excision, or amputation
Plague	Flea bite (bubonic plague), inhalation (pneumonic plague)	1D6 days	None	1D6	Fever, chills, lymph node swelling, coughing (if pneumonic), shock	Antibiotics
HIV/AIDS	Injection or unprotected sex	1D6 months	None	1D6	Weight loss, fever, swelling of lymph glands, total collapse of immune system	No cure; persistent; antivirals can can stabilize
Ebola virus	Contact with infected blood, bodies, or meat	1D6 days	–40	1D6	Fever, diarrhea, nausea, bleeding, shock	None

Optional Spot Rules for Weapons

There's a staggering variety of personal firearms and weaponry. Their usefulness in adventures may be limited, of course, depending on who or what the Protagonists face.

The primary game statistics relating to different types of weapons may be found on the Example Weapons Table on page 18. The availability of any class of weapon will be dictated by the scarcity of weapon resources in the particular game setting (see preceding section).

What follows are some spot rules for Protagonists who have access to common 'modern-day' (20th or 21st Century) weapons.

Concealing Weapons

Knives and pistols can be concealed under ordinary clothing. Someone deliberately looking for a concealed weapon can attempt an **Alertness** test to spot it. A heavy pistol or especially big knife means a +20% Alertness bonus.

If a Protagonist is wearing an overcoat or duster, they can attempt to conceal a bigger gun like a submachine gun or sawed-off shotgun, or a larger hand weapon (e.g., a hatchet or machete) and incur no Alertness bonus.

There's no way to conceal a full-size rifle or a large melee weapon.

Hand-to-Hand Weapons

Unarmed attacks, like punching, kicking, and strangling, use the **Unarmed** Combat skill. All melee weapons use the **Melee Weapons** skill.

Primitive Ranged Weapons

Old-fashioned ranged weapons that are aimed (e.g., crossbows, bow, and slings) use the **Firearms** skill even though they aren't firearms. All such weapons require some kind of ammunition (arrows, bolts, bow) and are useless if the supply is exhausted. Primitive weapons that are thrown (e.g., spears) use **Athletics** skill.

Firearms

Depending on when and where the game is set, the Protagonists may have easy access to a range of different firearms. Firearms can be heavily accessorized. Popular gun add-ons include tactical lights, sound suppressors, holographic sights, telescopic sights, night sights, and targeting lasers. Many rifles can also be fitted with an under-barrel shotgun or grenade launcher.

Pistols

Lightweight pistols fire low-powered cartridges and are of limited use even against humans. Medium pistols are the standard sidearms in law enforcement and the military everywhere. They fire moderately powerful rounds. Most revolvers hold six shots, but some late models hold seven or eight. Pocket revolvers sometimes take only five. There's a huge variety of ammunition capacities for semiautomatic pistol magazines, but 15 is typical, although 17 or even 20 is not uncommon. Large-caliber pistols often carry less. A typical figure for a heavy pistol is eight.

Shotguns

A typical pump-action shotgun holds five shots, although there are many with extended magazines for eight or more. Double-barrel shotguns hold one shot per barrel and can fire both barrels at one target with one attack roll. Shotguns can fire shot (a spread of small projectiles), slugs (a single heavy bullet), or "non-lethal" ammunition such as bean bag rounds, baton rounds, or rubber shot.

FIRING SHOT: Grants a +20% bonus to hit at all ranges: at point-blank due to the target being so close (see **ATTACK MODIFIERS** in the SRD) and beyond that due to the spread of projectiles. If the target has an Armor rating due to armor or cover, double it.

FIRING BOTH BARRELS: You can fire both barrels of a double-barrel shotgun at one target with one attack roll. That inflicts an extra +1D8 damage at base range. It adds no damage beyond base range as the shot or the slugs separate.

OTHER GAUGES: These rules assume a standard 12-gauge shotgun. Modify the damage by +2 for a heavier gauge or −2 for a lighter gauge.

Submachine Guns

Submachine guns fire full-automatic bursts but are often also capable of semi-automatic fire. When firing semi-automatic, the weapon inflicts ordinary damage; with automatic fire, it uses a Lethality rating (see **LETHALITY RATING** in the SRD).

Rifles and Carbines

Rifles fire more powerful cartridges than pistols or submachine guns, for better penetration, wounding, and range. However, they are also bulkier. Some military rifles — assault rifles in smaller calibers and automatic rifles in heavier calibers — are capable of firing full-automatic bursts with Lethality ratings. Especially heavy rifles have Lethality ratings with single shots.

Older rifles and many hunting rifles use a bolt action that must be manually worked before each shot, which delays aiming. An attack with one in the turn immediately after it's already been fired is at −20%. A bolt-action rifle gets no benefit from the **AIM** action in the turn immediately after it's fired.

>> Unusual Ammunition
Most small-arms ammunition uses the standard, listed damage ratings. Special types are available. **ARMOR-PIERCING:** Pistols, rifles, and submachine guns can fire bullets designed to pierce body armor. An armor piercing bullet reduces Armor by 5 (see **ARMOR PIERCING WEAPONS** in the SRD; this replaces the weapon's usual Armor Piercing rating, if any), but it does −1 damage (to a minimum of 1 point). **HOLLOW POINT:** Pistols, rifles, and submachine guns can fire expanding bullets designed to cause greater tissue trauma at the expense of penetration. A hollow point round does +1 damage but armor is twice as effective against it.

Heavy Weapons, Demolitions and Artillery

Many unnatural things that Protagonists face are inscrutable perversions of physics no more vulnerable to explosions than they are to crucifixes. This never stops Protagonists from trying.

The Base Range for each weapon reflects the fact that it needs to be accurate enough only to get a target within the Kill Radius. Machine guns fired off their bipod, tripod, or vehicle mount halve Base Range.

Many of these weapons actually fire in automatic bursts as well, which is subsumed under their Lethality ratings and Kill Radius. The Ammo Capacity of these weapons also varies widely, often depending on the vehicle on which they are mounted.

Only the lightest of Heavy Weapons will be commonly found, usually in military bases and the like. Most of the heavier ones are vehicle-mounted or specialized gear designed for military support units; these will typically be hard for the Protagonists to get their hands on, and even harder for them to transport to where they need firepower.

Weapons with Special Effects

Some types of weapons do something other than (or as well as) inflicting damage to Hit Points.

Tear Gas and Pepper Spray

These irritant chemicals make eyes tear, lungs seize, and exposed tissues sting like hell. If hit, the target must make a **CON×5** test or be stunned and suffer a penalty (usually -20%) to all actions for one hour. If the CON×5 roll succeeds, the

target is not stunned and suffers half the usual penalty. As described in the SRD, **STUNNED** individuals can't take further combat actions until they succeed at a **CON×5** test, which may be attempted once per turn.

A tear gas grenade only needs to land near a target to have effect, so the attack roll has a bonus of +20%. A tear gas grenade's cloud lingers in the air only a minute or two. Pepper spray is best used before combat begins, when no attack rolls are needed. If a pepper spray attack roll fails, the attacker partially sprays themself. The attacker must make a **CON×5** test at +20% to avoid being stunned and suffers a −20% penalty for one hour.

Wearing a gas mask protects against these effects but incurs a −20% penalty to **Alertness** and **Search** tests.

Stun Grenades

A "flash-bang" is a grenade that makes a huge noise and bright flash which deafens, blinds and staggers everyone within a 10-yard radius (indoors) or 5 yards (outdoors).

Each target is stunned (unable to act until a **CON×5** test succeeds; check each turn). After the stun wears off, the target suffers a −40% penalty to all actions for 1D6 turns. (Having eye or ear protection reduces the penalty to −20%.)

A stun grenade only needs to land near a target to have effect, so the attack roll has a bonus of +20%. If someone is tossing it into a closed room with the benefit of surprise, it doesn't even require a roll.

Bright Lights

A bright flashlight in darkness can dazzle someone up to 10 yards away by shining it in the target's eyes. This is an action in combat. It requires a **DEX×5** test, which is automatically **opposed by the target's DEX×5** test. A dazzled target is at a −20% penalty to all rolls for 1D6 turns.

Electroshock Weapons

A conducted energy device or stun gun discharges a high-voltage electrical shock into the target, causing the target's muscles to spasm violently. The victim must roll a **CON×5** test to resist being stunned. If stunned, they are unable to act until a **CON×5** test succeeds (attempted each turn). After the stun wears off, the victim suffers a −20% penalty to all actions for 1D20 turns.

Human bodies are excellent conductors of electricity. Anyone holding the target of an electroshock attack suffers the same effects.

Equipment and Resources

All localizations of Cthulhu Eternal use similar mechanics for assessing the success of Protagonists' efforts to scrounge for scarce supplies or items, or attempt to solve problems by combining items with jury-rigging. The primary mechanical differences lie in the specific skills used.

For Protagonists in Modern Age games:

- Attempts to **scrounge equipment/supplies** from likely locations in the environment – tests against the **Search** skill.
- Attempts to **jury-rig** a contraption – tests against **Craft skill specializations or Technology Use (at the GM's discretion)**.

Vehicles

The table below provides some examples of the types of vehicles common to the Modern Age.

Speed

There are two broad categories of vehicle speed: Surface and Air. Any vehicle with an Air Speed rating can automatically outrun a vehicle with a Surface Speed rating (except for Hot Air Balloons, which can't outrun any vehicle, and Zeppelins which are considered equivalent speed to a Slow Surface vehicle).

Within the same vehicle category, some are faster than others. A vehicle with a 'Fast' rating grants a +20% bonus to any **Drive** or **Pilot** test to pursue or escape. A 'Slow' vehicle incurs a −20% penalty instead. An 'Average' rating confers no modifier.

Jet planes have a speed rating of 'Special.' A jet automatically outruns any vehicle except another jet, and a fighter jet outruns any other kind of jet.

A vehicle that's notorious for poor handling or that's in bad shape might counts as 'heavily worn' or 'junk' (see above) at the GM's discretion.

Some Example Vehicles

>> Example Vehicles			
Vehicle Type	Hit Points	Armor	Speed
Motorcycle	15—20	0	Fast
Medium Car	25—30	3	Average
4WD or Jeep	30—35	3	Average
Armored Car	40	10	Slow
Small Truck	35—40	3	Average
Semi-Trailer	45	3	Slow
Tank	90	20	Slow
Speedboat	25	0	Average
Hovercraft	35	3	Average
Jet Ski	15	0	Fast
Air Vehicles			
Helicopter	20	0	Average
Light Plane	25	0	Average
Hot Air Balloon	10	0	Slow (see nearby)
Zeppelin	20	0	Slow-Surface
Passenger Jet	50	0	Special (see nearby)
Fighter Jet	40	0	Special (see nearby)

Ramming

The Game Moderator decides how deadly a collision ought to be. Here are a few suggestions for a vehicle's ramming damage.

AT LOW SPEED: 1D6 or 2D6 damage.

AT MODERATE SPEED: roll half the vehicle's maximum HP as a Lethality rating. A "Slow" vehicle cannot go faster than this.

AT HIGH SPEED: roll the vehicle's maximum HP as a Lethality rating.

If the target is a HUGE creature or another vehicle, the ramming vehicle suffers half ramming damage based on the target's HP.

A vehicle's Armor rating acts as Armor Piercing for its ramming damage.

Every passenger in a ramming vehicle takes 1D6 damage. Every passenger in a rammed vehicle takes 2D6 damage. A worn seat belt or active air bag halves the damage. A passenger in a vehicle that rams a target less than HUGE size suffers no damage.

Sanity

Most of the game mechanics surrounding Sanity do not vary between localizations of Cthulhu Eternal, however there are some small changes created through differences in available skills.

- The main skill used by Modern Age characters attempting to cure a patient of their mental illness, is: **Psychoanalyze.**

Disorders

Although the ways in which the human mind responds to stresses and mental illness have not changed for centuries, the labels applied to mental disorders have varied from era to era. To keep the descriptions of mental disorders feeling "contemporary" to a given era, localizations define their own sets of disorders. For Modern Age games, the following set are recommended.

Addiction

Your Protagonist relies on a harmful habit or substance to get by. However much harm the addiction causes, your Protagonist needs the relief it offers. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, an overwhelming need. Feeding it usually imparts a −20% penalty to stats and skills for a few hours due to intoxication or distraction. And even in the best of times, going 24 hours without feeding the addiction costs 1D6 WP and prevents your Protagonist from recovering any WP. Every further 24 hours costs 1D6 WP. At 2 or fewer WP, your Protagonist does irrational, self-destructive things to feed the addiction.

Amnesia

This is a common disorder from encounters with the unnatural. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, which erases all memory of the episode until your Protagonist finds a way to bring it back.

Depression

Acute depression means total despair and a crushing inability to get anything done. It sometimes takes the shape of overwhelming guilt. An acute episode is triggered by reminders of past traumas your Protagonist suffered or inflicted, which can come in the most surprising forms and moments. During an acute episode, every skill or stat test costs 1D4 WP.

Hysterical Blindness / Deafness / Paralysis

Collectively called conversion disorder, this can manifest either as non-physical blindness, deafness, or paralysis (pick one). Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, which leaves your Protagonist blind, deaf, or paralyzed with numbness and tremors until the source of stress goes away.

Mania

Your Protagonist displays a euphoric and perhaps irritable mood that is consistently present. This may include frenzied activity for no obvious reason, uncharacteristic garrulousness, a random stream-of-consciousness flow of ideas, or difficulty sleeping. An acute episode is triggered whenever your Protagonist loses 2+ SAN in a single roll. During an acute episode all tasks which require concentration or fine control are at **one-fifth chance.**

Megalomania / Narcissistic / Trumpism

What does it mean to look upon the face of a dead god and live? Some see themselves as messiahs, or as exempt from ordinary morality. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, in which every hint of doubt about your Protagonist's superiority fills them with indignation. That causes every use of a stat or skill to get help or make a good impression to fail.

Multiple Personalities

Most of the time, your Protagonist seems fine. Suffering temporary insanity or reaching the Breaking Point triggers an acute episode, in which your Protagonist takes on an alternate identity with its own personality and memories. Over

time, more identities may surface. The Game Moderator decides when and whether you keep control of your Protagonist's behavior.

Obsession

Your Protagonist becomes fixated on some person, place, event, act, or idea. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, which lasts days. In that time, any long-term action or skill use—anything taking more than a few hours—is at −20% because your Protagonist's mind is so often wrapped around its obsession.

Paranoia

A state of extreme suspicion, in which a fear of invisible enemies pervades one's world-view. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode. Unless your Protagonist finds a way to stifle their paranoia, they can't trust or rely on anyone. Every event, every disagreement or source of suspicion is a clue to a conspiracy against the Protagonist.

Phobia or Philia

A common affliction arising from traumatic experiences is the development of an irrational fear of something related (directly or by association) with the incident. These are called phobias and can be quite debilitating. Whenever a Protagonist is in the presence of a trigger for their phobia, they must make a **SAN** test (even if the trigger is not terrifying in any way to others). Failure means an acute episode has been triggered, during which there's little choice but to suffer the Flee or Submit response to temporary insanity (see the SRD). A nearby box provides some examples of phobias; searching online will reveal a huge array of other (sometimes quite weird) phobias.

A less common response to experiencing something shocking is the development of an irrational fetish or allure for something odd that is associated with the situation (perhaps which somehow related to the Protagonist's survival). These are called philias and work in a similar way to phobias in that whenever the afflicted Protagonist is in the presence of their irrational fetish a **SAN** roll is required to maintain any degree of self-control. If failed, an acute episode results during which the Game Moderator will dictate your Protagonist's actions until they regain control. The list of phobias shown nearby can be converted into philias by simply inverting them: for example, where scotophobia is a fear of darkness, scotophilia is an obsessive and irrational predisposition to shroud oneself in darkness.

Psychogenic Fugue

Your Protagonist may shut down into catatonia or wander off in an unconnected daze. It often manifests in the face of emotional or personal complications. Suffering temporary insanity or reaching the Breaking Point triggers an acute episode during which your Protagonist may disappear for days at a time, returning with no memory of their recent past.

Schizoid

Your Protagonist's personality changes towards an uncharacteristic emotionlessness. They will be perceived as cold or aloof by most people. This can have a devastating effect on interpersonal relationships. In game terms, all personal interaction skill tests or **CHA** tests are halved at any time. Whenever your Protagonist loses 2+ SAN on any single roll, they suffer an acute episode during which the emotionlessness amplifies to the point where CHA tests must be made at **one-fifth** chance. Such episodes usually last a few days.

PTSD aka "Shell Shock"

Post-traumatic stress disorder is a psychiatric disorder that occurs following life-threatening events. Some people shake off such horrors, while others have stress reactions. Victims of Shell Shock/PTSD relive the experience through nightmares and flashbacks, have difficulty sleeping, are subject to depression, and can be overcome by anxiety when presented with a similar situation. An acute episode is triggered by reminders of past traumas your Protagonist suffered or inflicted. In an acute episode, the Game Moderator chooses one effect: your Protagonist either reacts violently to threats only the Protagonist perceives, or suffers an acute depressive episode. (See **DEPRESSION** on page 26 for details.)

Phobias

- ACROPHOBIA: Fear of heights
- AGOROPHOBIA: Fear of open places
- AILUROPHOBIA: Fear of cats
- ANDROPHOBIA (for female Protagonists): Fear of males
- APIPHOBIA: Fear of bees
- ARACHNOPHOBIA: Fear of spiders
- ASTROPHOBIA: Fear of thunder, lightning and storms
- BACTERIOPHOBIA: Fear of bacteria
- BACTRACHOPHOBIA: Fear of frogs and toads
- BATHOPHOBIA: Fear of the deep sea
- BELONEPHOBIA: Fear of pins and needles
- BOTANOPHOBIA: Fear of plants
- CATOPTROPHOBIA: Fear of mirrors
- CLAUSTROPHOBIA: Fear of confined spaces
- DEMOPHOBIA: Fear of crowds
- DENDROPHOBIA: Fear of trees
- DORAPHOBIA: Fear of fur
- ENTOPHOBIA: Fear of insects
- GYNEPHOBIA (for male Protagonists): Fear of females
- HEMATOPHOBIA: Fear of blood
- HYLEPHOBIA: Fear of forests
- IATROPHOBIA: Fear of doctors
- MONOPHOBIA: Fear of being alone
- NECROPHOBIA: Fear of dead things
- OPHIOPHOBIA: Fear of snakes
- PYROPHOBIA: Fear of fire
- SCOTOPHOBIA: Fear of darkness
- TAPHEPHOBIA: Fear of being buried alive
- TECHNOPHOBIA: Fear of technology
- THALASSOPHOBIA: Fear of the sea
- TRICHOPHOBIA: Fear of hair
- TRISKADEKAPHOBIA: Fear of the number 13
- XENOPHOBIA: Fear of foreigners
- ZOOPHOBIA: Fear of Animals

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